

Alex Rivera

Software Engineer

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Backend-leaning full-stack engineer with 8 years of experience building reliable, observable services for developer tooling and fintech platforms. Enjoys mentoring, incident response, and turning ambiguous requirements into shipped software.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer Northwind Systems Mar 2022 – Present

Lead engineer on the payments platform team, owning reliability and developer experience for a service processing millions of transactions per day.

- Redesigned the retry and idempotency layer, cutting duplicate-charge incidents by 92%
- Introduced structured tracing across 12 services, reducing mean time to diagnose outages from hours to minutes
- Mentored 4 junior engineers, two of whom were promoted within a year

Software Engineer Fernwood Labs Jun 2018 – Feb 2022

Built and maintained internal developer tooling used by 150+ engineers, including a CLI for local environment provisioning.

- Shipped a self-service CLI that cut new-engineer onboarding time from 2 days to 3 hours
- Migrated the CI pipeline to containerized runners, reducing average build time by 40%

EDUCATION

University of Washington Bachelor of Science, Computer Science Sep 2010 – Jun 2014

SKILLS

- Backend Development:** Node.js, Go, PostgreSQL, gRPC
- Distributed Systems:** Kafka, Redis, Idempotency, Observability
- Cloud Infrastructure:** AWS, Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes
- Developer Tooling:** CLI design, CI/CD, Build systems

PROJECTS

retryable Jan 2021 – Nov 2021

- An open-source idempotency and retry library for Node.js HTTP clients.
- Adopted by 6 companies within the first year
 - Over 1,200 GitHub stars

PUBLICATIONS

Idempotency Keys at Scale: Lessons from Production Payments Systems InfoQ Sep 2023